

Prayers for our World and the Church

4th October 2025

Psalm 116:16-17

[16] O Lord, surely I am Your servant, I am Your servant, the son of Your handmaid, You have loosed my bonds.

[17] To You I shall offer a sacrifice of thanksgiving, And call upon the name of the Lord.

Let us pray...

Thanks to God

O Lord, we gather together before You today to honour You as our Saviour and Lord, the only One Who can loose our bonds, and the One Who is worthy to receive our thanksgiving sacrifice of praise.

We know that we cannot be masters of our own lives, for we are sinners who followed in the footsteps of Adam and Eve in seeking to live apart from Your gracious rule. We thank You that in Your grace and mercy You sent Jesus to save us from the guilt, the power and the penalty of our sin.

We thank You that we have been forgiven, our relationship to You has been restored, and we can now offer a sacrifice of praise.

We thank You that we will shortly take part in the Lord's Supper, commemorating the Cross and Resurrection. We thank You for Jesus' righteousness, which He freely granted us in exchange for our old unrighteousness. We thank You that as the Son of Man and the Son of God, He bridged the gap between heaven and Earth, so that we could walk in newness of life. We confess our sinfulness and weakness in the face of temptation, and thank You for sending the Holy Spirit, to be with us and sanctify us daily, so that we become more like Jesus, fit to enter Heaven, and remain in Your holy presence.

The Wide World... and the Wider Church

We thank You for the church, the worldwide Body of Christ, working in each congregation where Your people gather. We thank You that it is the pillar and guardian of the Truth, the declarer of Your Word to those in this world who are still blinded by the father of lies. We pray for them to see the True Light of the World, and that they would be saved, just as we are. We pray for Your persecuted church in places like Africa, Asia where violence is obvious, but also in places like Europe, America and Australia, where people lose their jobs or are shunned in quiet ways for upholding Your Word.

Ashburton

We pray for Your work here at Ashburton, as we serve in the work of the Kingdom. We pray for the ministries of teaching and discipleship, for our Sunday School leaders who serve to bless the children with the knowledge of Your Word and Your saving grace.

We continue in prayer for those in need of Your healing hand, especially remembering Joan, John and Gaye. We remember that we are a fellowship together, and pray for those travelling, that You would watch over them until they return to us.

We thank You for Douglas as he preaches Your Word today. We thank You for his faithful, wise and vigorous proclamation of Your teaching, which enables us to grow towards maturity in our faith and daily walk.

In His Precious Name we pray, Amen.